



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about the phone.



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How do you normally end a phone conversation?
- Have people ever just hung up their phone without saying goodbye?

Can Do Statements

- I can close phone conversations.
- I can talk about technology and gadgets.
- I can say what people are doing now or in the future.





Let's Explore!

Peter's phone keeps **dying***.

* "Dying" is an irregular form.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Tom:** Hey Pete. Are you still having trouble with your new phone?
- Peter:** Don't talk to me about that! I'm really upset right now.
- Tom:** What's going on? Are you still getting that crackling sound?
- Peter:** No, that's fine. The phone just keeps dying out of the blue. I can't do anything about it. The worst part is that I'm expecting a couple of important calls later! The dinner is at 7 tonight.
- Tom:** Aha, I see. Well, this is what you get when you buy a cool smartphone. They always stop working at some point!
- Peter:** I think you're right. Wait, I've got to run. The battery is almost dead!
- Tom:** Can you talk now?
- Peter:** I'm not sure anymore! It says battery fully charged but it means nothing to me!
- Tom:** Well, I guess it's good to be old-school sometimes. I'm very happy with my flip phone. I can talk for hours on this thing!
- Peter:** Maybe I'll buy one next time. Ok, I've got to run. I'm going to charge the battery.
- Tom:** Sure thing. I'll talk to you later!
- Peter:** Take care, man.





Let's Practice!

What does the future hold for Peter?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm / calls. / a / important / of / phone / expecting / couple

2. is / dinner / 7 / tonight. / The / at

3. next / buy / Maybe, / time. / I'll / one

4. again. / I'm / battery / charge / the / going / to

5. I'll / later. / to / talk / you



Let's Practice!

What's wrong with the phone?

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Are you still having trouble
2. Are you still getting
3. The phone just keeps
4. The battery
5. I'm very happy

COLUMN B

- a. that crackling sound?
- b. with my flip phone.
- c. is almost dead.
- d. with your new smartphone?
- e. dying out of the blue.





Extension Activity

Practice your phone etiquette with a partner.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Role play 3 different phone conversations.
- For each conversation, make sure you use expressions to end them properly.
- Be sure to be polite and friendly.
- Change roles with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I role play a telephone conversation.

☐ ☐

I talk about technology and gadgets.

☐ ☐

I talk about what I want to do in the future.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **smartphone** (noun): a cell phone that connects to the Internet and takes pictures
e.g. My smartphone stopped working!
- **battery** (noun): the part of a device that provides energy
e.g. The battery is almost dead.
- **charged** (adjective): full of energy
e.g. The battery is fully charged.
- **flip phone** (noun): an older model of cell phone that you can flip open
e.g. I can talk for hours with my flip phone.
- **old school** (expression): not trendy; out of fashion
e.g. It's good to be old school sometimes.
- **to die** (verb): to stop working
e.g. My phone keeps dying out of the blue.





Learning Points

Closing Phone Conversations

It's important to use expressions to close a phone conversation. You use polite expressions with people you don't know.

You can use more informal expressions with your friends or family.

Whenever you are talking on the phone, it can be difficult for a few reasons:

1. You are not able to see the other person you are speaking with.
2. You are not able to see how he or she is reacting to your conversation.

Informal Conversation	Polite Conversation
Talk to you soon. I've got to run. Bye. Take care. I'd better get going!	It's been nice talking to you. Good bye. Thank you for calling. I'll talk with you soon. I will call you back ...

Examples:

• **Bob:** *I've got to run. Talk to you later.*

Ted: *Sure thing. Take care, man.*

Talking About Future Actions

You can use four different tenses to talk about the future.

- When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal *will*.
- When you ask about intentions, you use *going to*.
- When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future, you use the Present Continuous tense.
- When you talk about schedules or timetables in the future, you use the Simple Present tense.

Verb Tense	Example
Will	Maybe I'll buy one next time.
Going to	I'm going to charge the battery again.
Present Continuous	I'm expecting a couple of important calls this evening.
Simple Present tense	The dinner is at 7 tonight.

